

intermodal, ensuring door-to-door transportation.

COUPLING

The mechanism for connecting rolling stock. Methods are standardized across a single line to allow any rolling stock to be coupled together.

See also Rolling stock.

CAB

Control room of a locomotive, housing the engine crew.

CAR, CARRIAGE, COACH

Various terms that describe a passenger-carrying vehicle.

CLASS

Group of locomotives built as per a common design. It can also refer to the level of comfort and services provided on a particular train, for instance, first class and second class.

CRIMINAL TRIBES

A discriminatory term that was first used during the British rule under the Criminal Tribes Act. The tribes listed under the Act were classified as “habitual criminals”. They were denotified in 1952.

CYLINDER

Enclosed chamber in which a piston moves to produce power that is transmitted to the wheels. On a steam locomotive, the piston is moved by the force of high pressure steam acting against it.

DIESEL-ELECTRIC

Any locomotive, multiple unit, or car that utilizes the diesel-electric system. In a diesel-electric, mechanical power generated by combustion is then converted into an electric charge in a generator or alternator, and this electricity is used to power motors that drive the axles.